

Advanced Computer Networks (CS6302)

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Wireless LANs

IEEE 802 ARCHITECTURE

- standardized protocol architecture for LANs, which encompasses physical, medium access control, and logical link control layers
- In OSI terms, higher-layer protocols (layer 3 or 4 and above) are independent of network architecture and are applicable to LANs, MANs, and WANs
- The IEEE 802 architecture has been adopted by all organizations working on the specification of LAN standards. It is generally referred to as the **IEEE 802 reference model**.

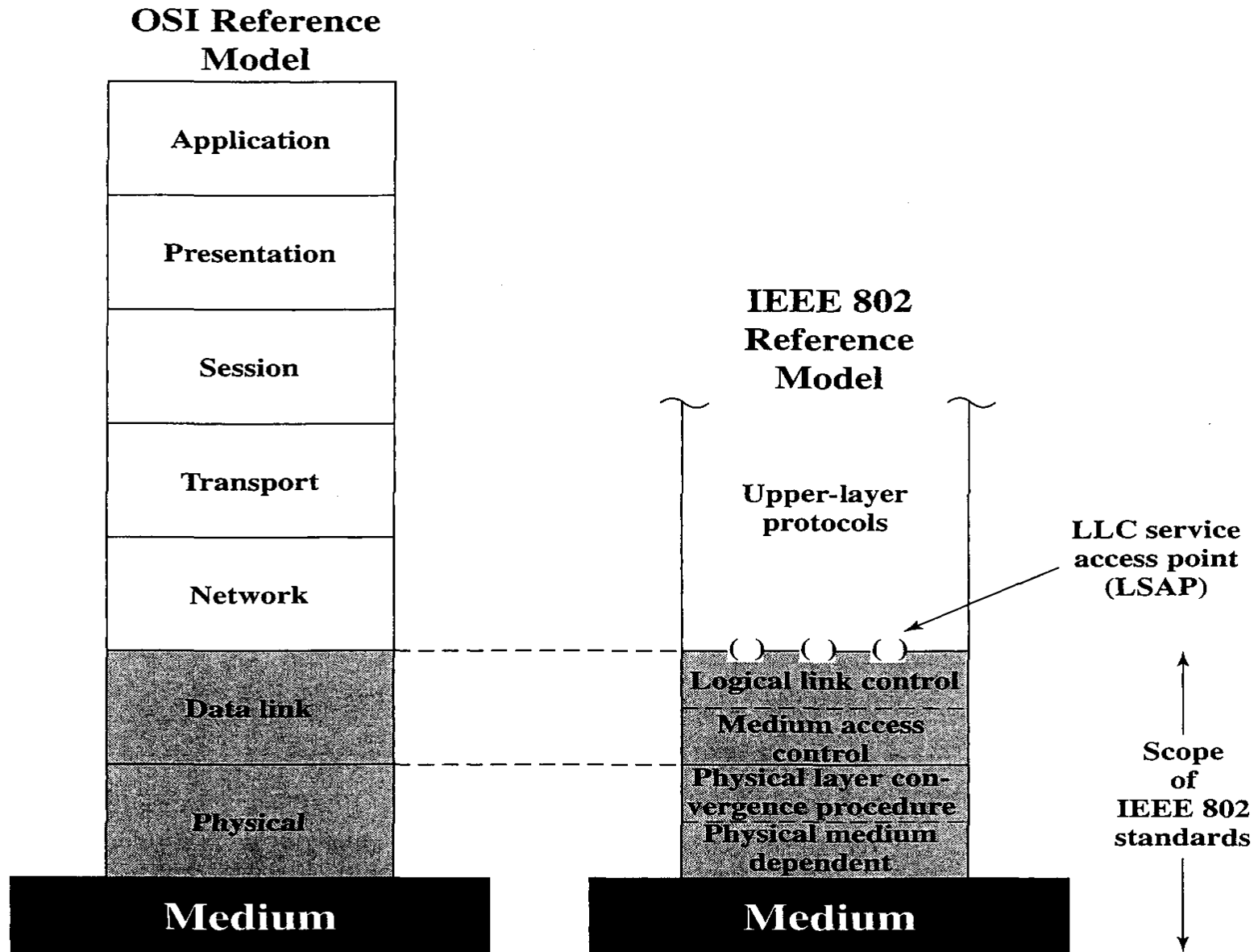
IEEE 802 ARCHITECTURE

- the lowest layer of the IEEE 802 reference model corresponds to the physical layer of the OSI model and includes such functions as
 - Encoding/decoding of signals (e.g., PSK, QAM, etc.)
 - Preamble generation/removal (for synchronization)
 - Bit transmission or reception
- In addition, the physical layer of the 802 model includes a specification of the transmission medium and the topology
- Generally, this is considered "below" the lowest layer of the OSI model

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- For some of the IEEE 802 standards, the physical layer is further subdivided into sublayers
 - **Physical layer convergence procedure (PLCP):** Defines a method of mapping 802.11 MAC layer protocol data units (MPDUs) into a framing format suitable for sending and receiving user data and management information between two or more stations using the associated PMD sublayer.
 - **Physical medium dependent sublayer (PMD):** Defines the characteristics of, and method of transmitting and receiving, user data through a wireless medium between two or more stations

IEEE 802 ARCHITECTURE



IEEE 802 ARCHITECTURE

- Above the physical layer are the functions associated with providing service to LAN users. These include
 - MAC**
 - On transmission, assemble data into a frame with address and error detection fields.
 - On reception, disassemble frame, and perform address recognition and error detection.
 - Govern access to the LAN transmission medium.
 - LLC**
 - Provide an interface to higher layers and perform flow and error control

IEEE 802 ARCHITECTURE

- The separation in layer2 is done for the following reasons:
 - The logic required to manage access to a shared-access medium is not found in traditional layer 2 data link control.
 - For the same LLC, several MAC options may be provided.

IEEE 802 ARCHITECTURE

- Higher-level data are passed down to LLC, which appends control information as a header, creating an LLC protocol data unit (PDU).
- This control information is used in the operation of the LLC protocol.
- The entire LLC PDU is then passed down to the MAC layer, which appends control information at the front and back of the packet, forming a MAC frame.
- the control information in the frame is needed for the operation of the MAC protocol.

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

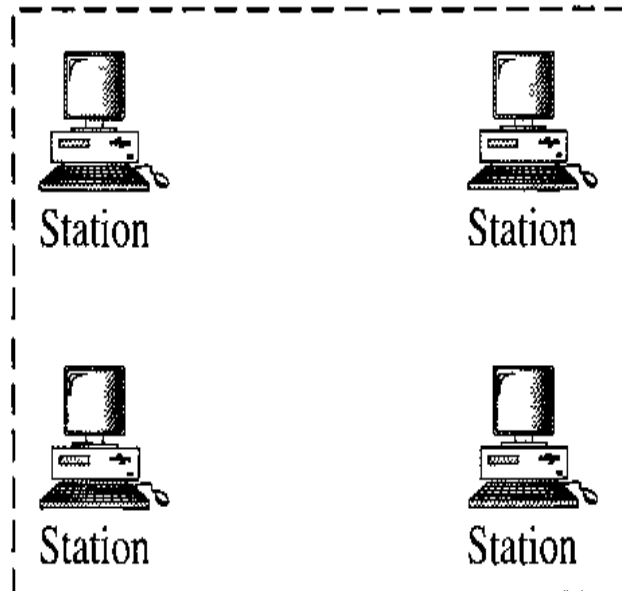
- IEEE has defined the specifications for a wireless LAN, called IEEE 802.11, which covers the physical and data link layers.
- ***Basic Service Set***
 - IEEE 802.11 defines the basic service set (BSS) as the building block of a wireless LAN.
 - A basic service set is made of stationary or mobile wireless stations and an optional central base station, known as the access point (AP).
 - The BSS without an AP is a stand-alone network and cannot send data to other BSSs.
 - It is called an *ad hoc architecture*. In this architecture, stations can form a network
 - without the need of an AP; they can locate one another and agree to be part of a BSS.
 - A BSS with an AP is sometimes referred to as an *infrastructure* network.

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

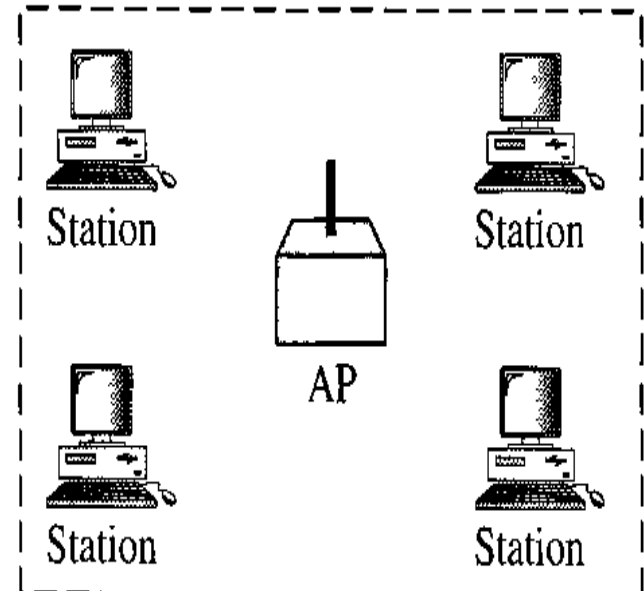
- ***Basic Service Set***

BSS: Basic service set

AP: Access point



Ad hoc network (BSS without an AP)



Infrastructure (BSS with an AP)

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- *Extended Service Set*
 - An extended service set (ESS) is made up of two or more BSSs with APs.
 - the BSSs are connected through a *distribution system*, which is usually a wired LAN. The distribution system connects the APs in the BSSs.
 - IEEE 802.11 does not restrict the distribution system; it can be any IEEE LAN such as an Ethernet.
 - Note that the extended service set uses two types of stations: mobile and stationary.
 - The mobile stations are normal stations inside a BSS. The stationary stations are AP stations that are part of a wired LAN.

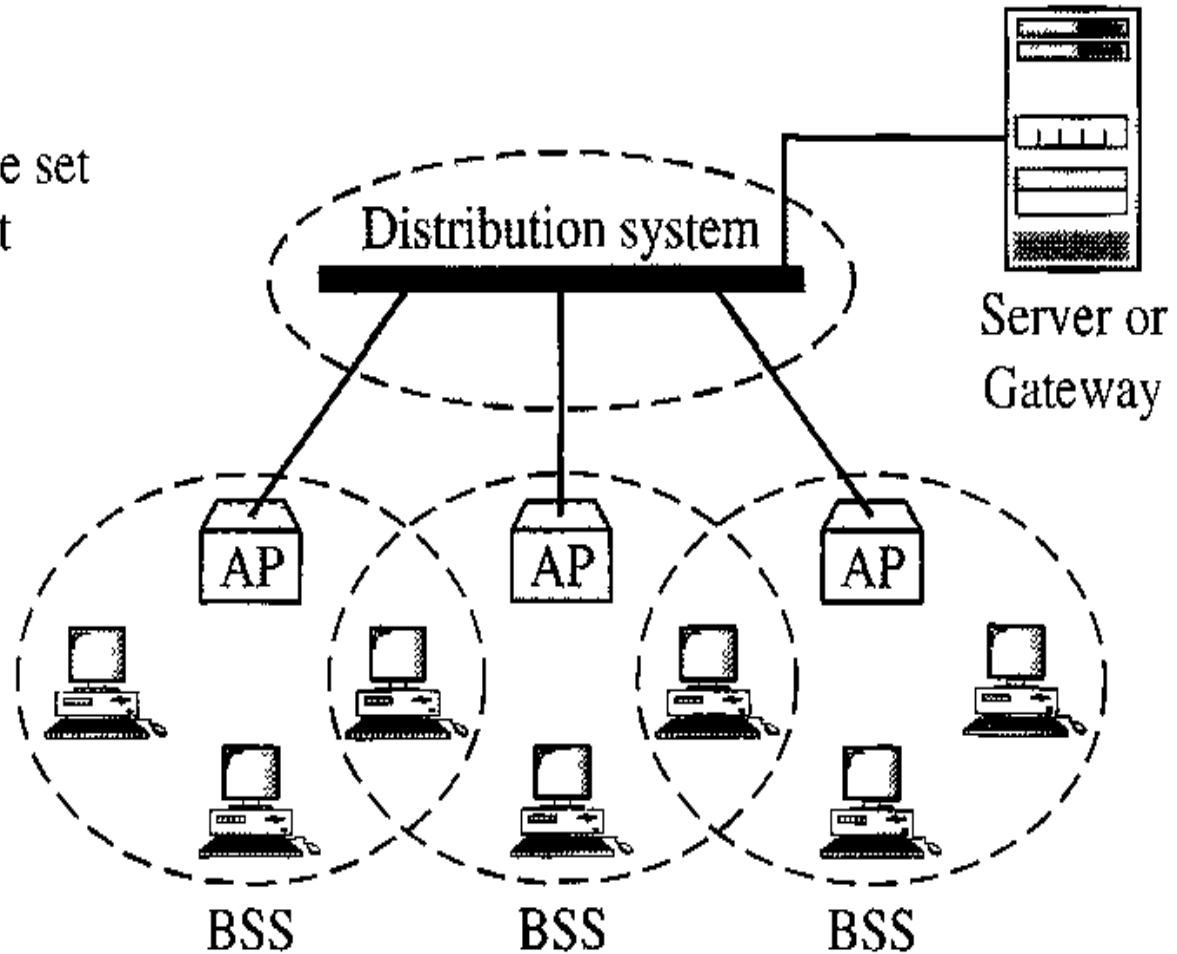
IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- *Extended Service Set*

ESS: Extended service set

BSS: Basic service set

AP: Access point



IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- When BSSs are connected, the stations within reach of one another can communicate without the use of an AP.
- communication between two stations in two different BSSs usually occurs via two APs.
- The idea is similar to communication in a cellular network if we consider each BSS to be a cell and each AP to be a base station.
- Note that a mobile station can belong to more than one BSS at the same time.

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- *Station Types*

- IEEE 802.11 defines three types of stations based on their mobility in a wireless LAN: **no-transition**, **BSS-transition**, and **ESS-transition mobility**.
- A station with no-transition mobility is either stationary (not moving) or moving only inside a BSS.
- A station with BSS-transition mobility can move from one BSS to another, but the movement is confined inside one ESS.
- A station with ESS-transition mobility can move from one ESS to another. However, IEEE 802.11 does not guarantee that communication is continuous during the move.

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

A station must maintain an association with the AP

- **Association:**

- Establishes an initial association with an AP before a station can transmit/receive frames on a wireless LAN, its identity and address must be known.
- The AP can then communicate this information to other APs within the ESS to facilitate routing and delivery of frames.

- **Reassociation:**

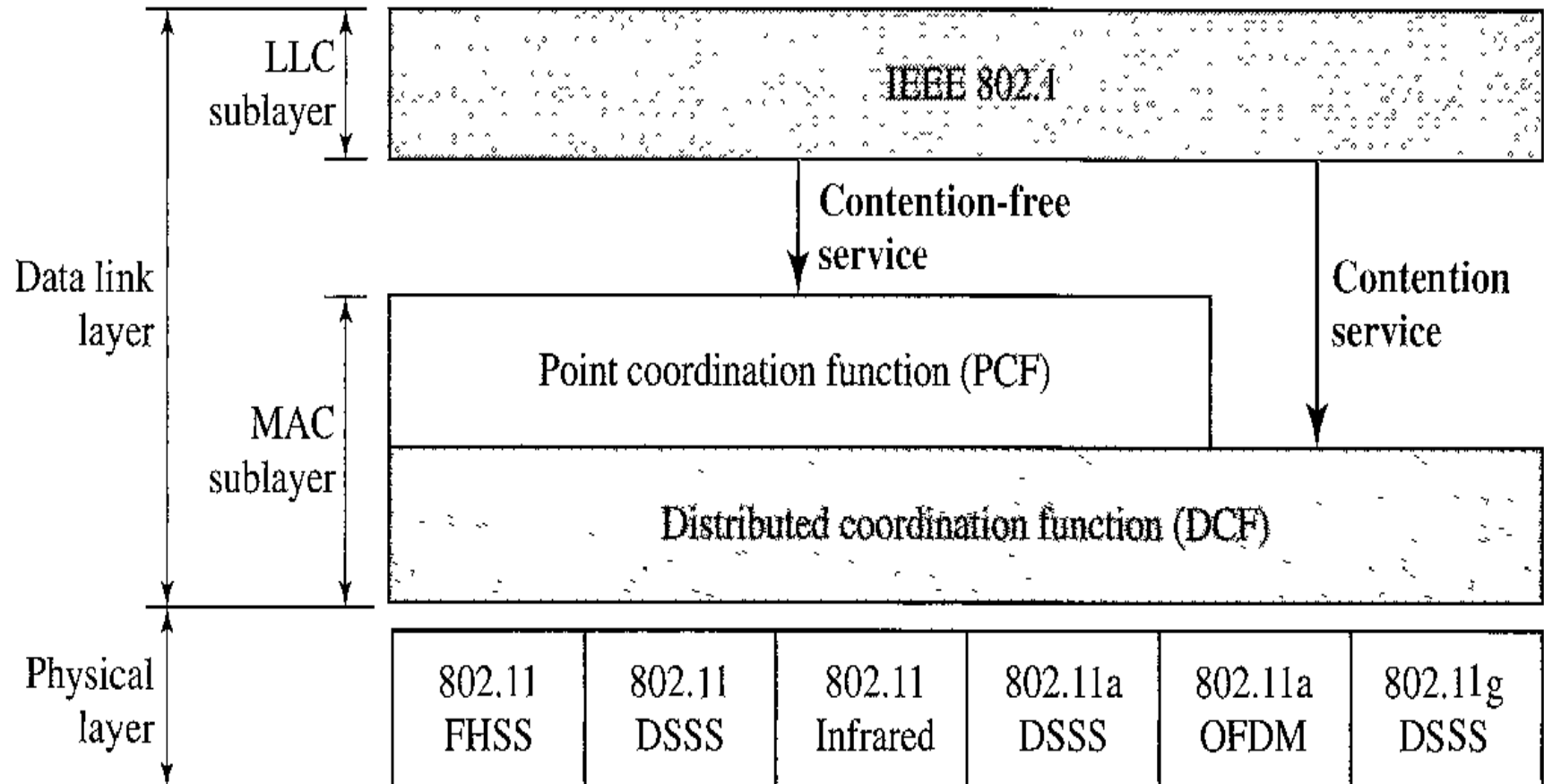
- Enables an established association to be transferred from one AP to another, allowing a mobile station to move from one BSS to another.

- **Disassociation:**

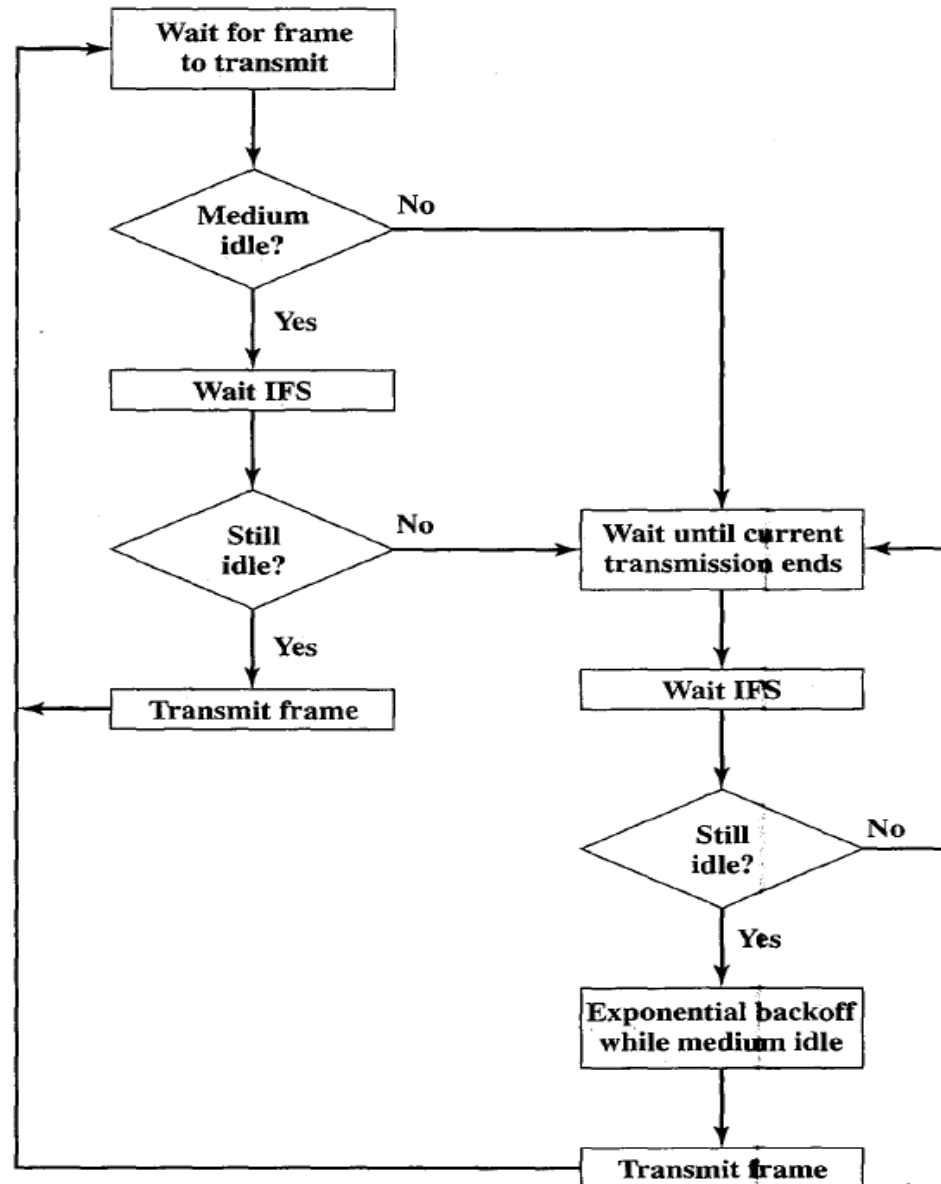
- A notification from either a station or an AP that an existing association is terminated.
- A station should give this notification before leaving an ESS or shutting down. However, the MAC management protects itself against stations that disappear without notification.

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- MAC Sublayer
 - IEEE 802.11 defines two MAC sublayers: the distributed coordination function (DCF) and point coordination function (PCF).



IEEE 802.11 Medium Access Control Logic



IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- *Distributed Coordination Function*
 - DCF uses *CSMA/CA* as the access method. Wireless LANs cannot implement *CSMA/CD* for three reasons:
 - For collision detection a station must be able to send data and receive collision signals at the same time. This can mean costly stations and increased bandwidth requirements.
 - Collision may not be detected because of the hidden station problem.
 - The distance between stations can be great. Signal fading could prevent a station at one end from hearing a collision at the other end.

CSMA/ICA

1. Before sending a frame, the source station senses the medium by checking the energy level at the carrier frequency.
 - a. The channel uses a persistence strategy with back-off until the channel is idle.
 - b. After the station is found to be idle, the station waits for a period of time called the distributed interframe space (DIFS); then the station sends a the request to send (RTS).

CSMA/ICA

2. After receiving the RTS and waiting a period of time called the short interframe space (SIFS), the destination station sends a control frame, called the clear to send (CTS), to the source station.

- This control frame indicates that the destination station is ready to receive data.

CSMA/ICA

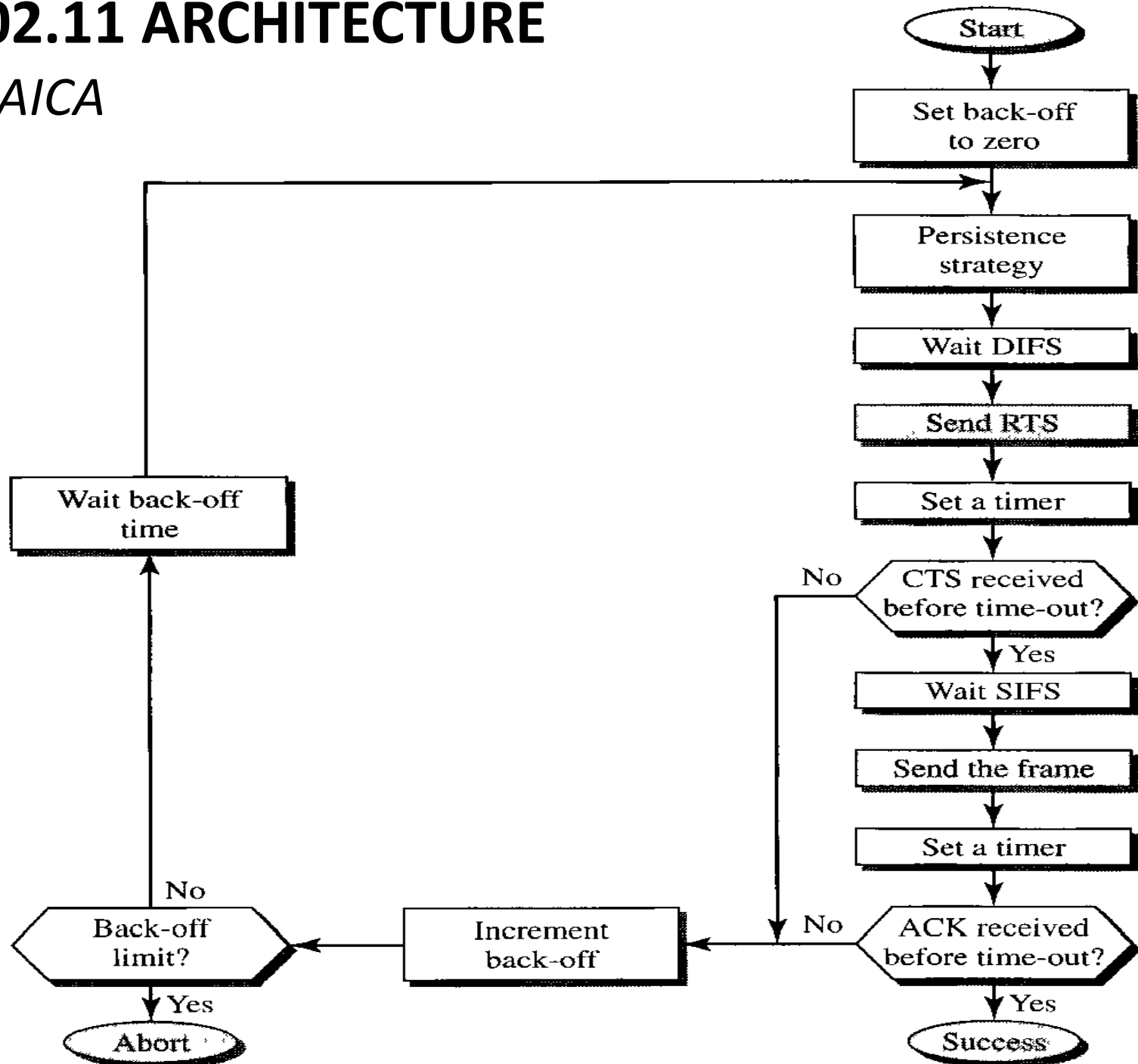
3. The source station sends data after waiting an amount of time equal to SIFS.

4. The destination station, after waiting an amount of time equal to SIFS, sends an acknowledgment to show that the frame has been received.

- Acknowledgment is needed in this protocol because the station does not have any means to check for the successful arrival of its data at the destination.
- On the other hand, the lack of collision in *CSMA/CD* is a kind of indication to the source that data have arrived.

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- CSMA/CA



The Binary Exponential Backoff Algorithm

- Procedure
 - After the **first collision**, each station waits either 0 or 1 slot times before trying again
 - After the **second collision**, each one picks either 0, 1, 2, or 3 at random and waits that number of slot times
 - ...
 - After the **k^{th} collision**, each station choose $0 \sim 2^k - 1$ slots, if $k < 10$
 - If $k \geq 10$, each station randomly choose $0 \sim 1023$ slots to defer its transmission

Exchange of data and control messages

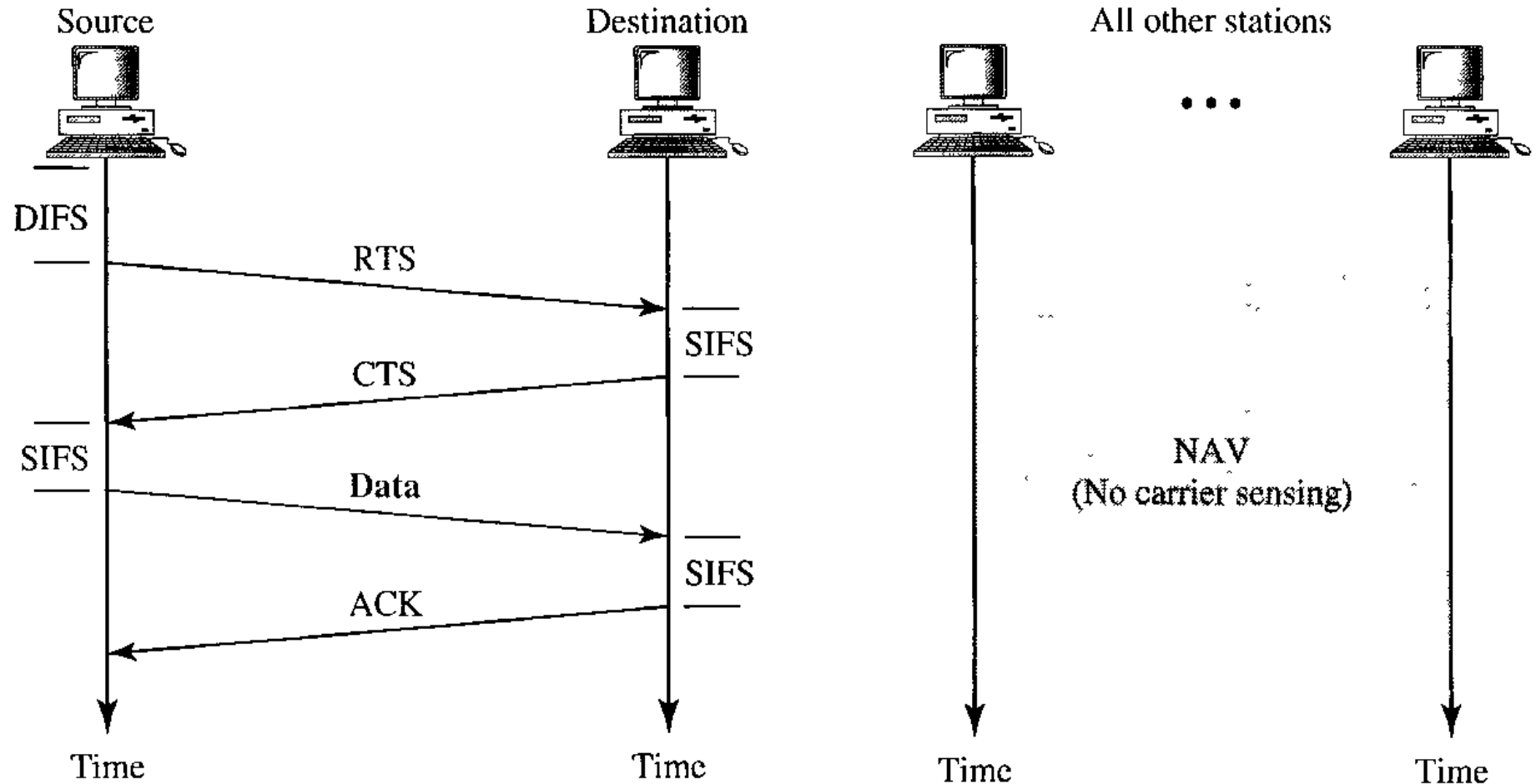
- When a station sends an RTS frame, it includes the **duration of time** that it needs to occupy the channel.
- The stations that are affected by this transmission create a timer called a network allocation vector (NAV) that shows how much time must pass before these stations are allowed to check the channel for idleness.
- Each time a station accesses the system and sends an RTS frame, other stations start their NAV.
- In other words, each station, before sensing the physical medium to see if it is idle, first checks its NAV to see if it has expired.

Cont...

- Collision During Handshaking (when RTS or CTS control frames are in transition, often called the handshaking period?)
- Two or more stations may try to send RTS frames at the same time. These control frames may collide.
- Because there is no mechanism for collision detection, the sender assumes there has been a collision if it has not received a CTS frame from the receiver.
- The back-off strategy is employed, and the sender tries again.

IEEE 802.11 ARCHITECTURE

- Exchange of data and control messages*

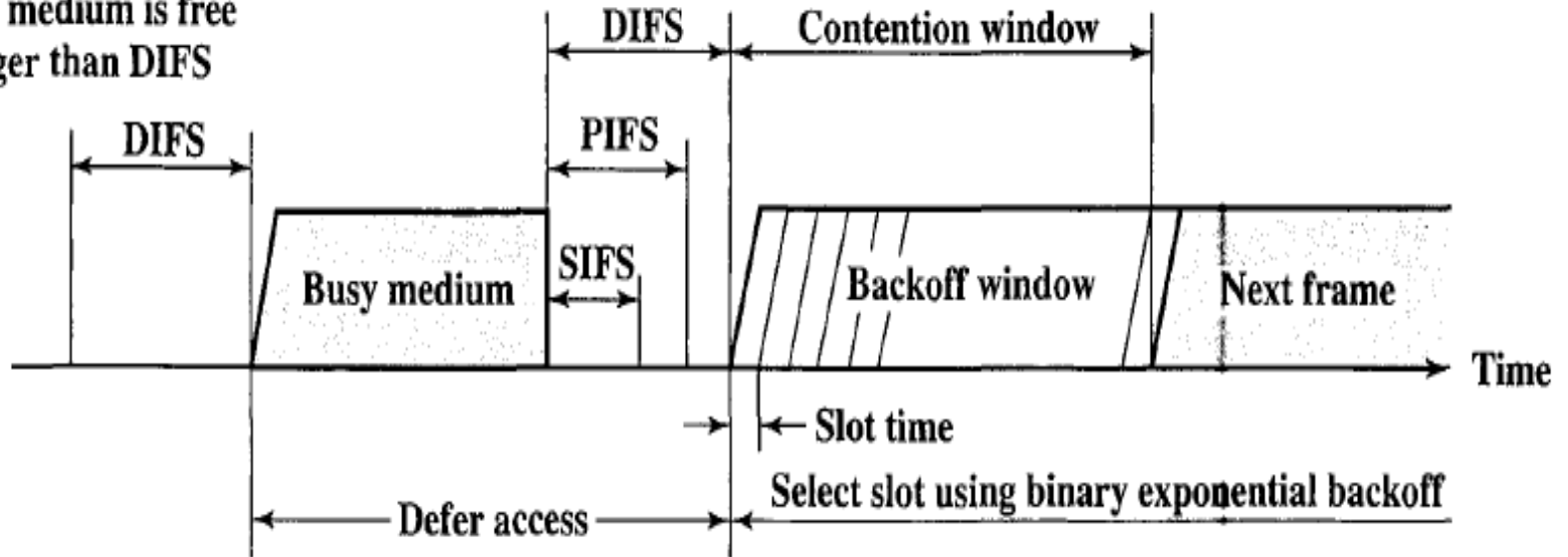


three values for IFS

- ***SIFS (short IFS)***: The shortest IFS, used for all immediate response actions
- ***PIFS (point coordination function IFS)***: A middlelength IFS, used by the centralized controller in the PCF scheme when issuing polls
- ***DIFS (distributed coordination function IFS)***: The longest IFS, used as a minimum delay for asynchronous frames contending for access

Access method

Immediate access
when medium is free
longer than DIFS



Point Coordination Function (PCF)

- The point coordination function (PCF) is an optional access method that can be implemented in an infrastructure network (not in an ad hoc network).
- It is implemented on top of the DCF and is used mostly for time-sensitive transmission and priority.

Point Coordination Function (PCF)

- PCF has a centralized, contention-free polling access method.
- The AP performs polling for stations that are capable of being polled.
- The stations are polled one after another, sending any data they have to the AP.

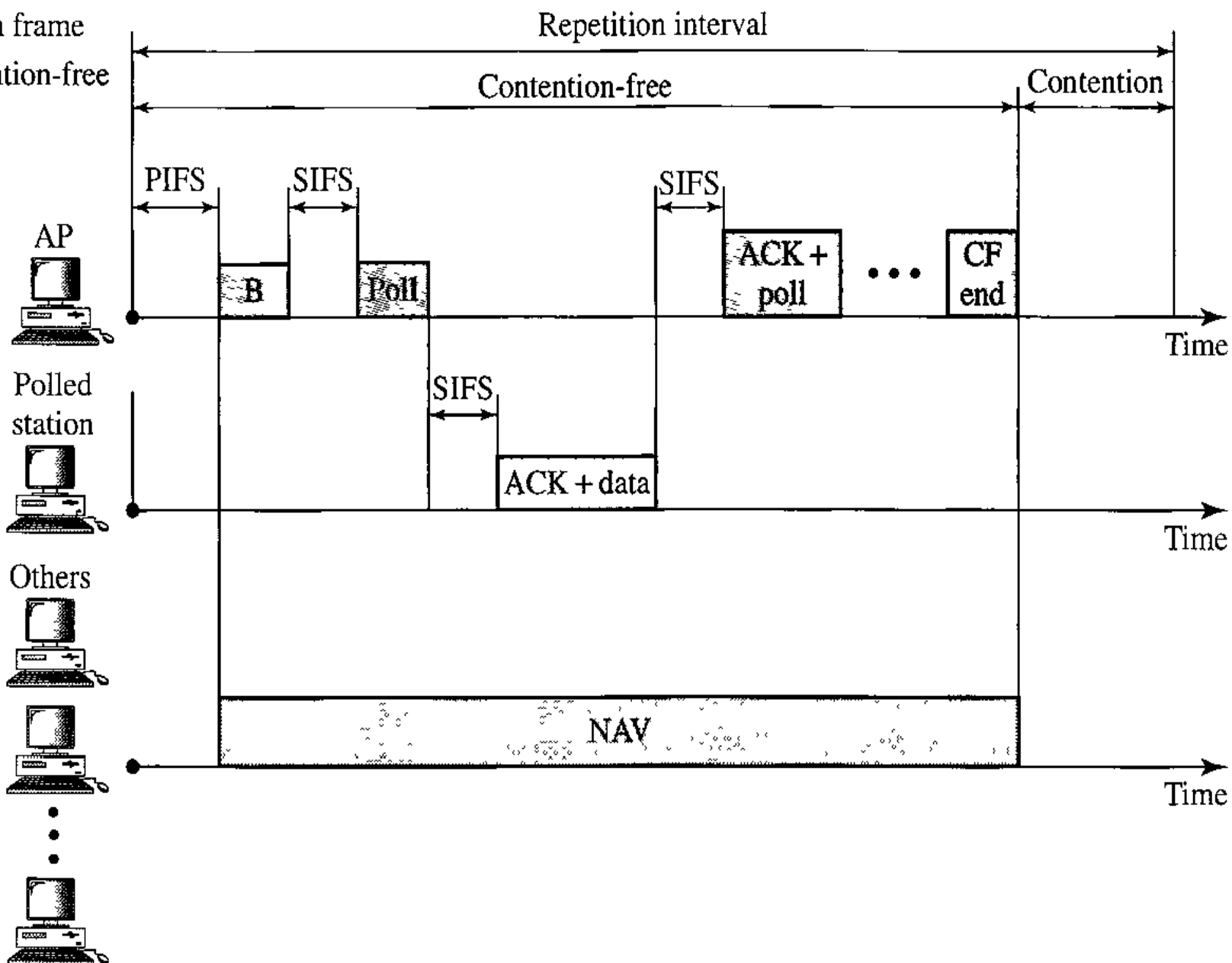
Point Coordination Function (PCF)

- To give priority to PCF over DCF, another set of interframe spaces has been defined: PIFS and SIFS.
- The SIFS is the same as that in DCF, but the PIFS (PCF IFS) is shorter than the DIFS.
 - This means that if, at the same time, a station wants to use only DCF and an AP wants to use PCF, the AP has priority.

Point Coordination Function (PCF)

- Due to the priority of PCF over DCF, stations that only use DCF may not gain access to the medium.
 - To prevent this, a repetition interval has been designed to cover both contention-free (PCF) and contention-based (DCF) traffic.
- The **repetition interval**, which is repeated continuously, starts with a special control frame, called a **beacon frame**.
- When the stations hear the beacon frame, they start their NAV for the duration of the contention-free period of the repetition interval.

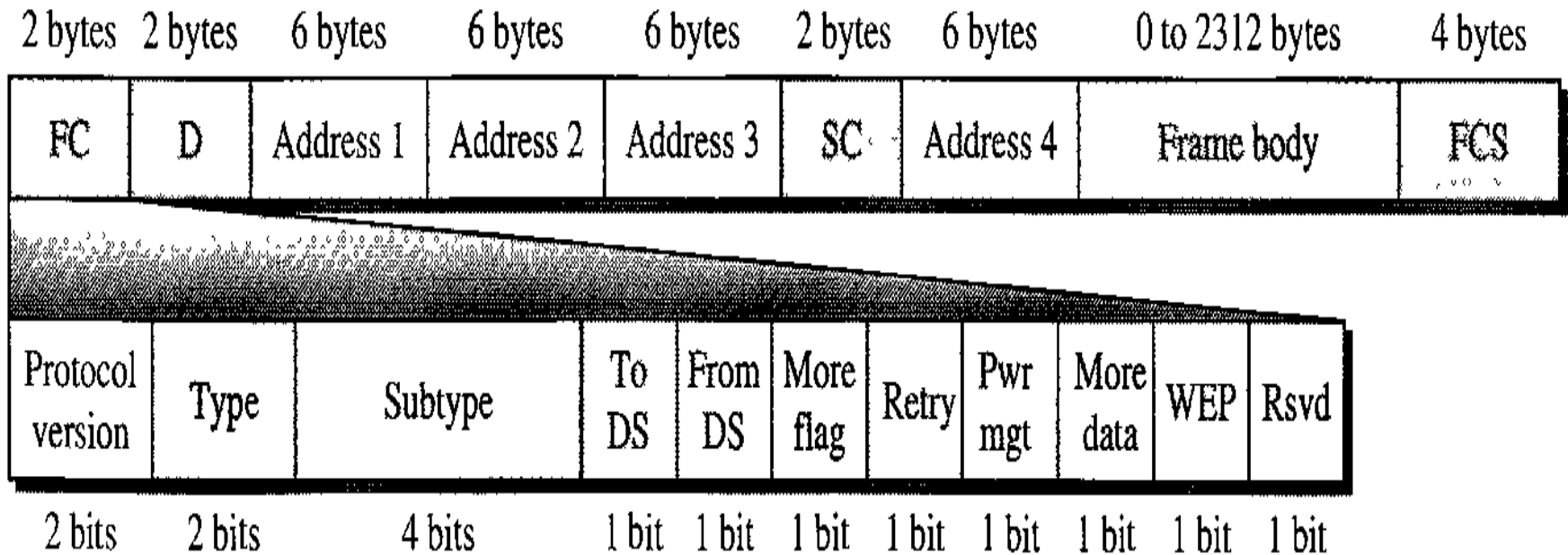
B: Beacon frame
CF: Contention-free



Fragmentation

- The wireless environment is very noisy; a corrupt frame has to be retransmitted.
- The protocol recommends fragmentation-the division of a large frame into smaller ones.
- It is more efficient to resend a small frame than a large one.

Frame Format



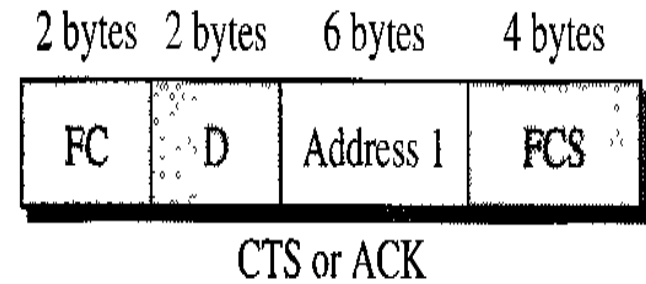
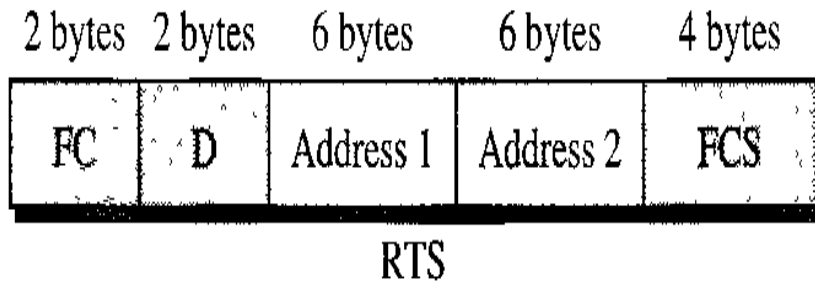
- **Frame control (FC).** The FC field is 2 bytes long and defines the type of frame and some control information.

Field	Explanation
Version	Current version is 0
Type	Type of information: management (00), control (01), data (10)
Subtype	Subtype of each type
To DS	Defined later
From DS	Defined later
More flag	When set to 1, means more fragments
Retry	When set to 1, means retransmitted frame
Pwr mgt	When set to 1, means station is in power management mode
More data	When set to 1, means station has more data to send
WEP	Wired Equivalent Privacy (encryption implemented)
Rsvd	Reserved

- **D.** In all frame types except one, this field defines the duration of the transmission that is used to set the value of NAV. In one control frame, this field defines the ID of the frame.
- **Addresses.** There are four address fields, each 6 bytes long. The meaning of each address field depends on the value of the *To DS* and *From DS* subfields.
- **Sequence control.** This field defines the sequence number of the frame to be used in flow control.
- **Frame body.** This field, which can be between 0 and 2312 bytes, contains information based on the type and the subtype defined in the FC field.
- **FCS.** The FCS field is 4 bytes long and contains a CRC-32 error detection sequence.

- *Frame Types*

- A wireless LAN defined by IEEE 802.11 has three categories of frames: management frames, control frames, and data frames.
- Management Frames: they are used for the initial communication between stations and access points.
- Control Frames: they are used for accessing the channel and acknowledging frames.

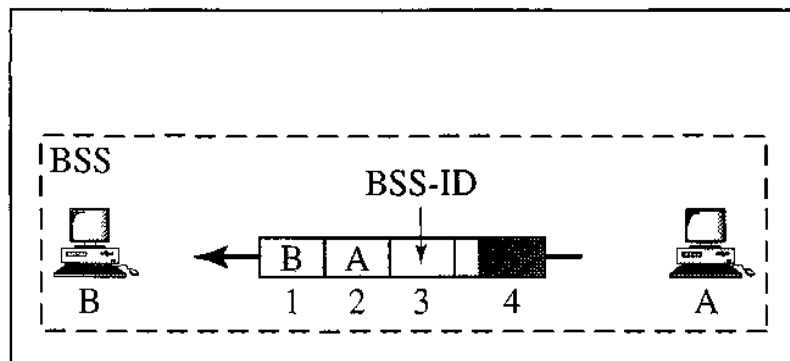


- For control frames the value of the type field is 01; the values of the subtype fields for frames as follows.

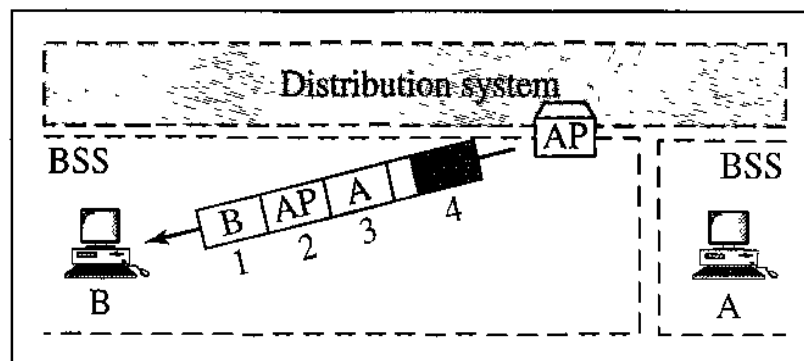
Subtype	Meaning
1011	Request to send (RTS)
1100	Clear to send (CTS)
1101	Acknowledgement (ACK)

- Addressing Mechanism
 - The IEEE 802.11 addressing mechanism specifies four cases, defined by the value of the two flags in the FC field, *To DS* and *From DS*.
 - Each flag can be either 0 or 1, resulting in four different situations.
 - The interpretation of the four addresses (address 1 to address 4) in the MAC frame depends on the value of these flags.

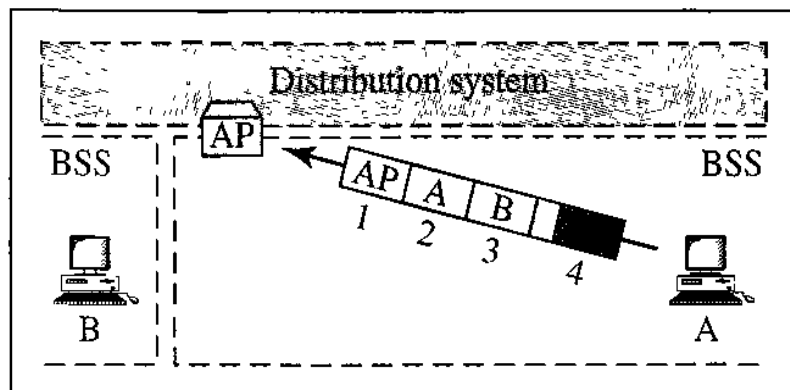
<i>To DS</i>	<i>From DS</i>	<i>Address 1</i>	<i>Address 2</i>	<i>Address 3</i>	<i>Address 4</i>
0	0	Destination	Source	BSS ID	N/A
0	1	Destination	Sending AP	Source	N/A
1	0	Receiving AP	Source	Destination	N/A
1	1	Receiving AP	Sending AP	Destination	Source



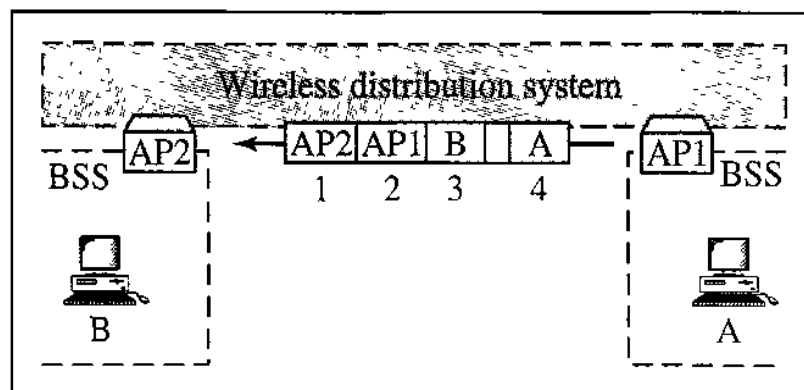
a. Case 1



b. Case 2

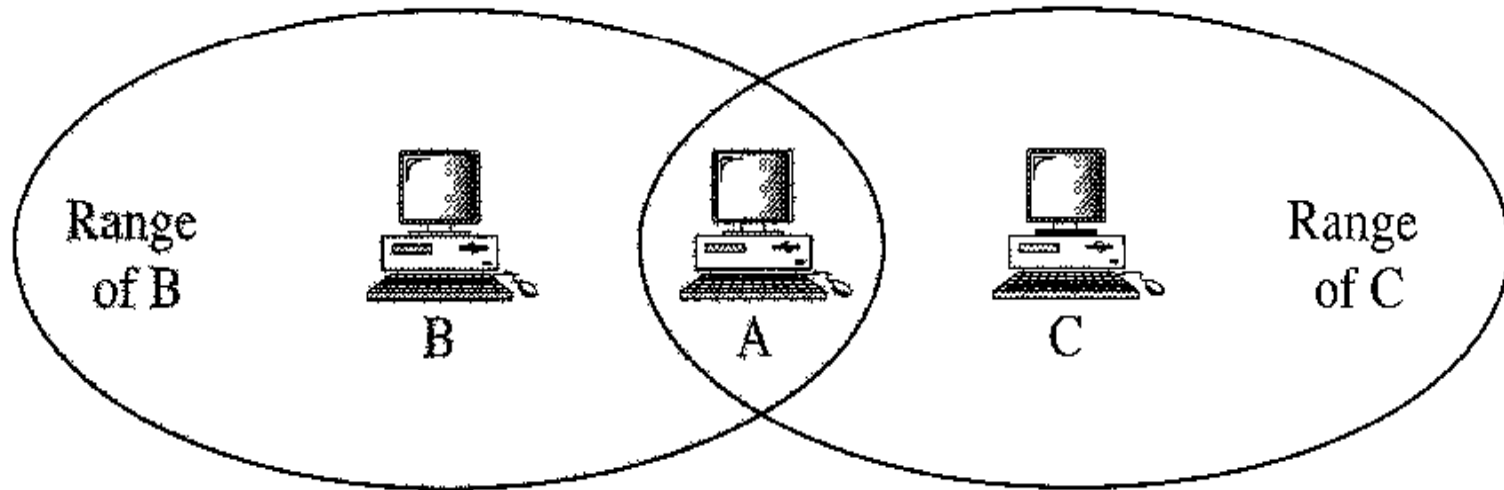


c. Case 3



d. Case 4

- Hidden Station Problem



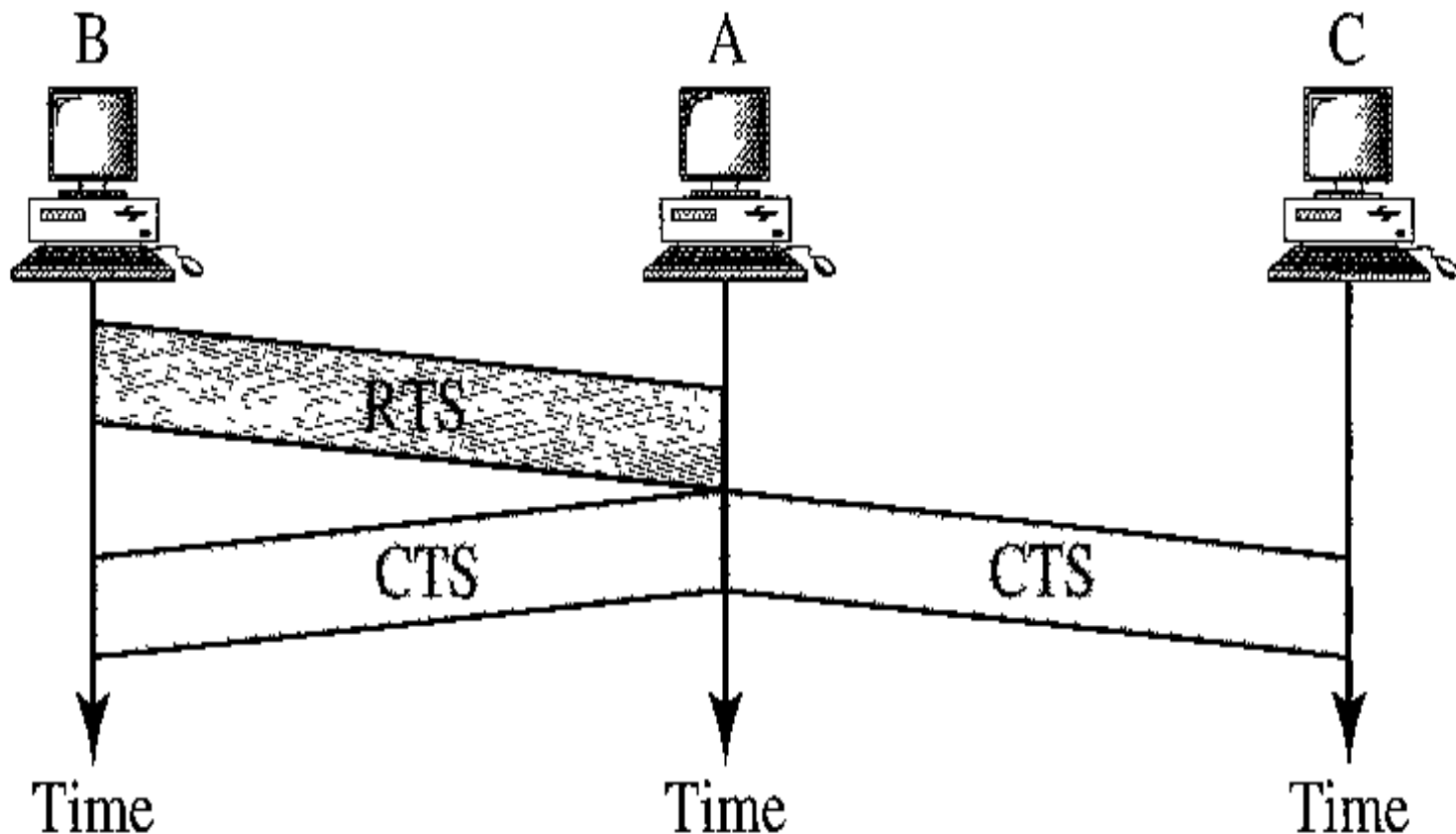
B and C are hidden from each other with respect to A.

Hidden Station Problem

- Assume that station B is sending data to station A.
- In the middle of this transmission, station C also has data to send to station A. However, station C is out of B's range and transmissions from B cannot reach C. Therefore C thinks the medium is free.
- Station C sends its data to A, which results in a collision at A because this station is receiving data from both B and C. In this case, we say that stations B and C are hidden from each other with respect to A.
- Hidden stations can reduce the capacity of the network because of the possibility of collision.

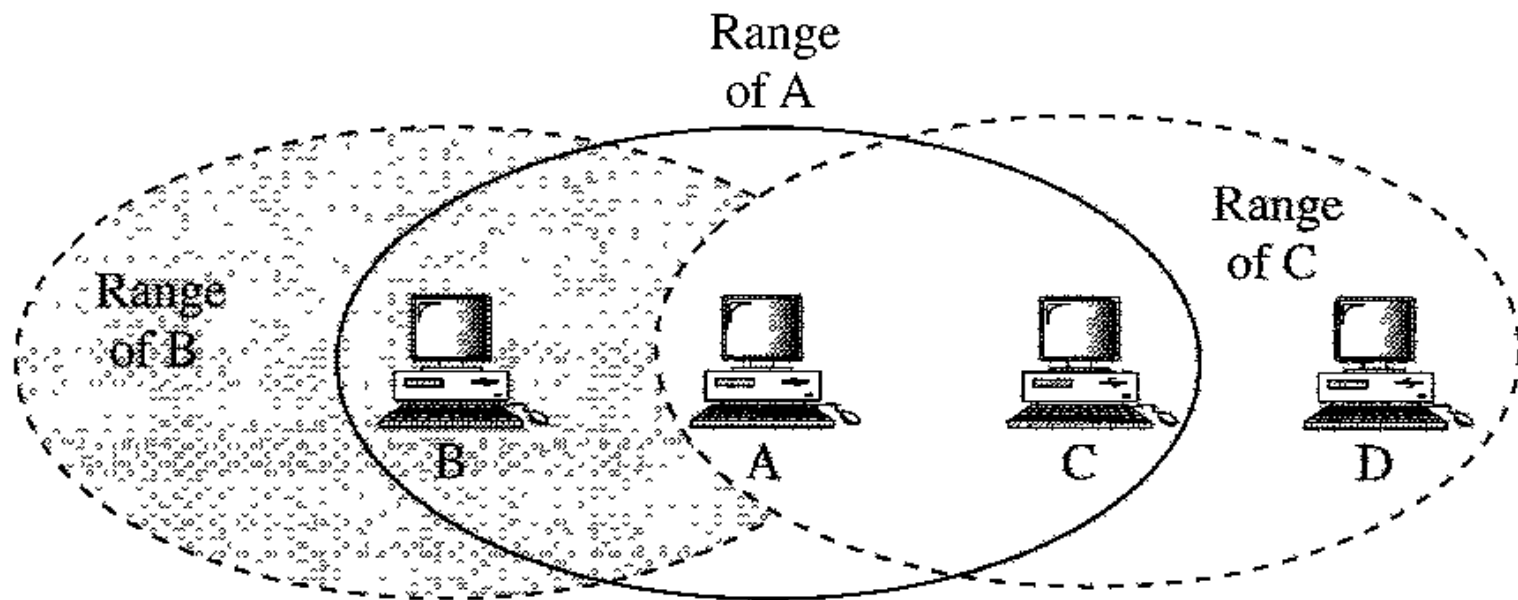
Hidden Station Problem

- The CTS frame in CSMA/CA handshake can prevent collision from a hidden station.



- Exposed Station Problem
 - In this problem a station refrains from using a channel when it is, in fact, available.
 - Station A is transmitting to station B.
 - Station C has some data to send to station D, which can be sent without interfering with the transmission from A to B. However, station C is exposed to transmission from A; it hears what A is sending and thus refrains from sending.
 - In other words, C is too conservative and wastes the capacity of the channel.

Exposed Station Problem

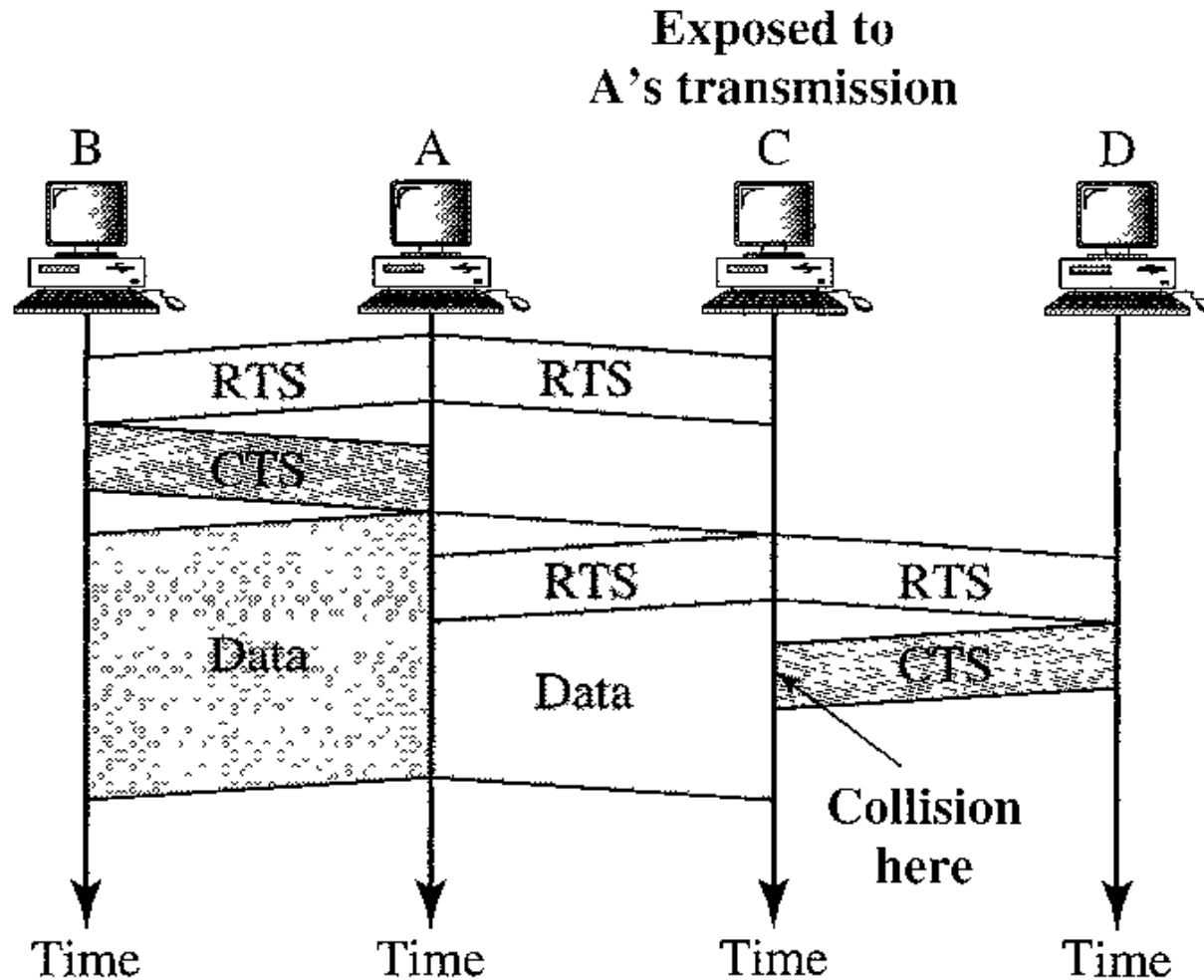


C is exposed to transmission from A to B.

Use of handshaking in exposed station problem

- Handshaking messages RTS and CTS cannot help in this case.
- Station C hears the RTS from A, but does not hear the CTS from B. Station C, after hearing the RTS from A, can wait for a time so that the CTS from B reaches A; it then sends an RTS to D to show that it needs to communicate with D. Both stations B and A may hear this RTS, but station A is in the sending state, not the receiving state.
- Station B, however, responds with a CTS. The problem is here. If station A has started sending its data, station C cannot hear the CTS from station D because of the collision; it cannot send its data to D. It remains exposed until A finishes sending its data

Use of handshaking in exposed station problem

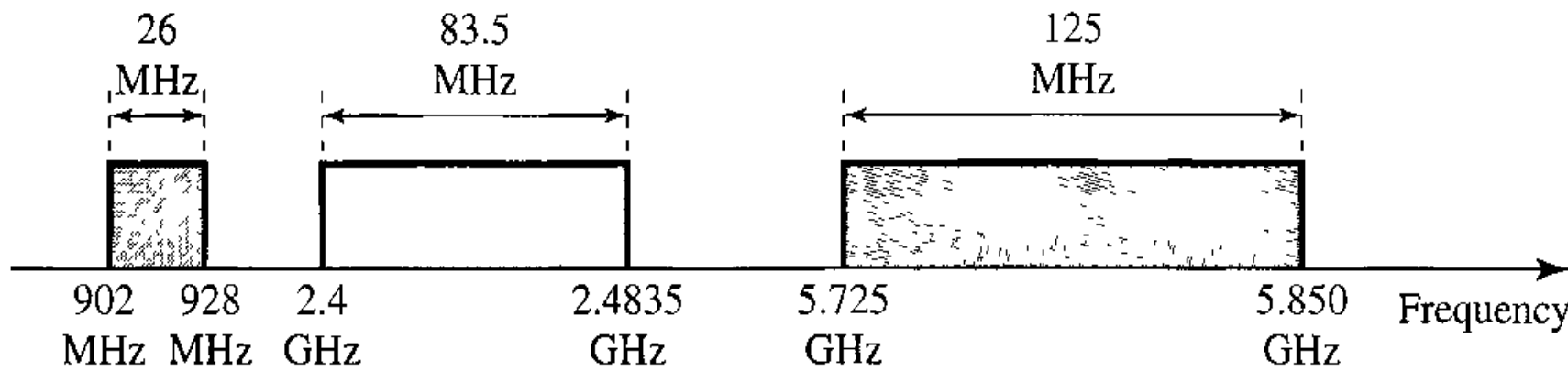


Physical Layer

<i>IEEE</i>	<i>Technique</i>	<i>Band</i>	<i>Modulation</i>	<i>Rate (Mbps)</i>
802.11	FHSS	2.4 GHz	FSK	1 and 2
	DSSS	2.4 GHz	PSK	1 and 2
		Infrared	PPM	1 and 2
802.11a	OFDM	5.725 GHz	PSK or QAM	6 to 54
802.11b	DSSS	2.4 GHz	PSK	5.5 and 11
802.11g	OFDM	2.4 GHz	Different	22 and 54

- All implementations, except the infrared, operate in the *industrial, scientific, and medical (ISM)* band, which defines three unlicensed bands in the three ranges 902-928 MHz, 2.400—2.4835 GHz, and 5.725-5.850 GHz

Physical Layer



- *IEEE 802.11 FHSS*

- IEEE 802.11 FHSS uses the frequency-hopping spread spectrum (FHSS) method
- FHSS uses the 2.4-GHz ISM band.
- The band is divided into 79 sub-bands of 1 MHz (and some guard bands). A pseudorandom number generator selects the hopping sequence.
- The modulation technique in this specification is either two-level FSK or four-level FSK with 1 or 2 bits/ baud, which results in a data rate of 1 or 2 Mbps

- *IEEE 802.11 DSSS*
 - IEEE 802.11 DSSS uses the direct sequence spread spectrum (DSSS) method.
 - DSSS uses the 2.4-GHz ISM band.
 - The modulation technique in this specification is PSK at 1Mbaud/s. The system allows 1 or 2 bits/ baud (BPSK or QPSK), which results in a data rate of 1 or 2 Mbps.

- *IEEE 802.11 Infrared*

- IEEE 802.11 infrared uses infrared light in the range of 800 to 950 nm. The modulation technique is called pulse position modulation (PPM).
- For a 1-Mbps data rate, a 4-bit sequence is first mapped into a 16-bit sequence in which only one bit is set to 1 and the rest are set to 0.
- For a 2-Mbps data rate, a 2-bit sequence is first mapped into a 4-bit sequence in which only one bit is set to 1 and the rest are set to 0.
- The mapped sequences are then converted to optical signals; the presence of light specifies 1, the absence of light specifies 0.

- *IEEE 802.11a OFDM*

- IEEE 802.11a OFDM describes the orthogonal frequency-division multiplexing (OFDM) method for signal generation in a 5-GHz ISM band.
- OFDM is similar to FDM, with one major difference: All the subbands are used by one source at a given time.
- Sources contend with one another at the data link layer for access. The band is divided into 52 subbands, with 48 subbands for sending 48 groups of bits at a time and 4 subbands for control information.
- The scheme is similar to ADSL. Dividing the band into subbands diminishes the effects of interference. If the subbands are used randomly, security can also be increased.
- OFDM uses PSK and QAM for modulation. The common data rates are 18 Mbps (PSK) and 54 Mbps (QAM).

- *IEEE 802.11b DSSS*

- IEEE 802.11b DSSS describes the high-rate direct sequence spread spectrum (HRDSSS) method for signal generation in the 2.4-GHz ISM band.
- HR-DSSS is similar to DSSS except for the encoding method, which is called complementary code keying (CCK).
- CCK encodes 4 or 8 bits to one CCK symbol. To be backward compatible with DSSS, HR-DSSS defines four data rates: 1, 2, 5.5, and 11 Mbps.
- The first two use the same modulation techniques as DSSS. The 5.5-Mbps version uses BPSK and transmits at 1.375 Mbaud/s with 4-bit CCK encoding.
- The 11-Mbps version uses QPSK and transmits at 1.375 Mbps with 8-bit CCK encoding.

- *IEEE 802.11g*

- This new specification defines forward error correction and OFDM using the 2.4-GHz ISM band.
- The modulation technique achieves a 22- or 54-Mbps data rate. It is backward compatible with 802.11b, but the modulation technique is OFDM.

BLUETOOTH

- Bluetooth is a wireless LAN technology designed to connect devices of different functions such as telephones, computers (desktop and laptop), cameras, and so on.
- A Bluetooth LAN is an ad hoc network, which means that the network is formed spontaneously; the devices, find each other and make a network called a piconet.
- A Bluetooth LAN can even be connected to the Internet if one of the gadgets has this capability.
- A Bluetooth LAN, by nature, cannot be large. If there are many gadgets that try to connect, there is chaos.

BLUETOOTH

- applications
 - Peripheral devices such as a wireless mouse or keyboard can communicate with the computer through this technology.
 - Monitoring devices can communicate with sensor devices in a small health care center.
 - Home security devices can use this technology to connect different sensors to the main security controller.

BLUETOOTH

- Bluetooth was originally started as a project by the Ericsson Company. It is named for Harald Blaatand, the king of Denmark (940-981).
- Today, Bluetooth technology is the implementation of a protocol defined by the IEEE 802.15 standard.
- The standard defines a wireless personal-area network (PAN) operable in an area the size of a room or a hall.

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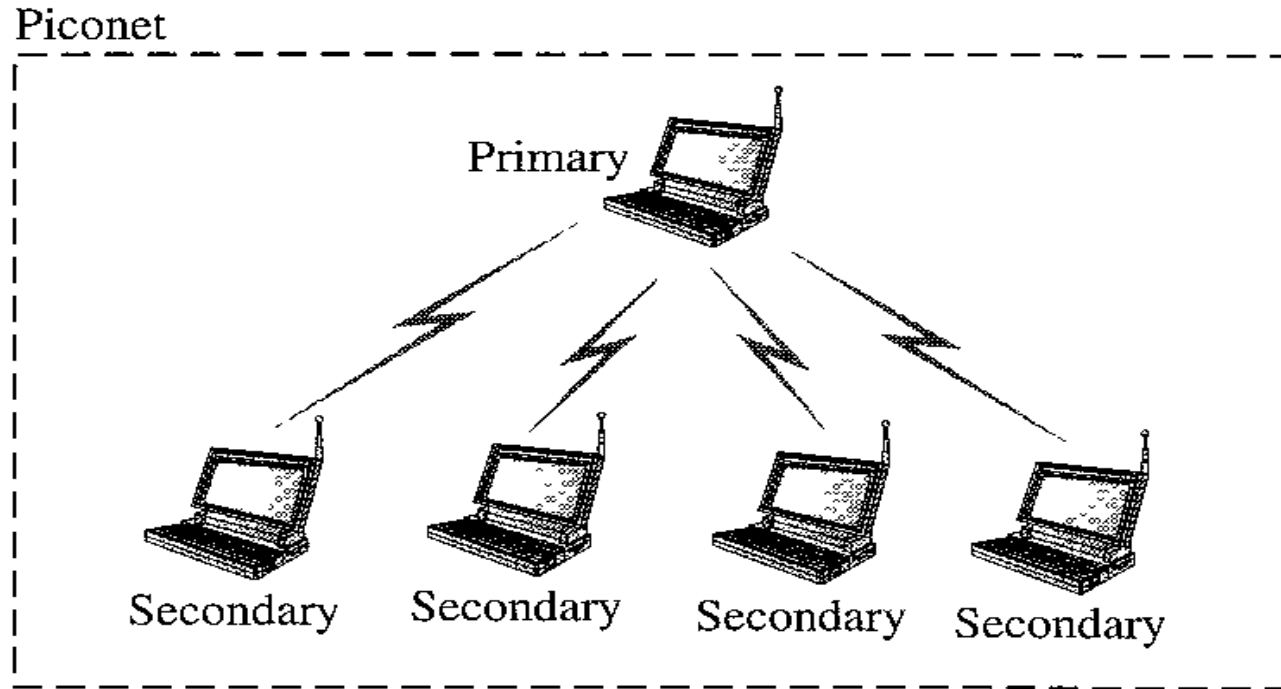
- **Architecture**

- Bluetooth defines two types of networks: **piconet** and **scatternet**

- *Piconets*

- A Bluetooth network is called a piconet, or a small net.
 - A piconet can have up to eight stations, one of which is called the primary; the rest are called secondaries.
 - All the secondary stations synchronize their clocks and hopping sequence with the primary.
 - Note that a piconet can have only one primary station.
 - The communication between the primary and the secondary can be one-to-one or one-to-many.

Piconet



- Although a piconet can have a maximum of seven secondaries, an additional eight secondaries can be in the *parked state*.
- A secondary in a parked state is synchronized with the primary, but cannot take part in communication until it is moved from the parked state.

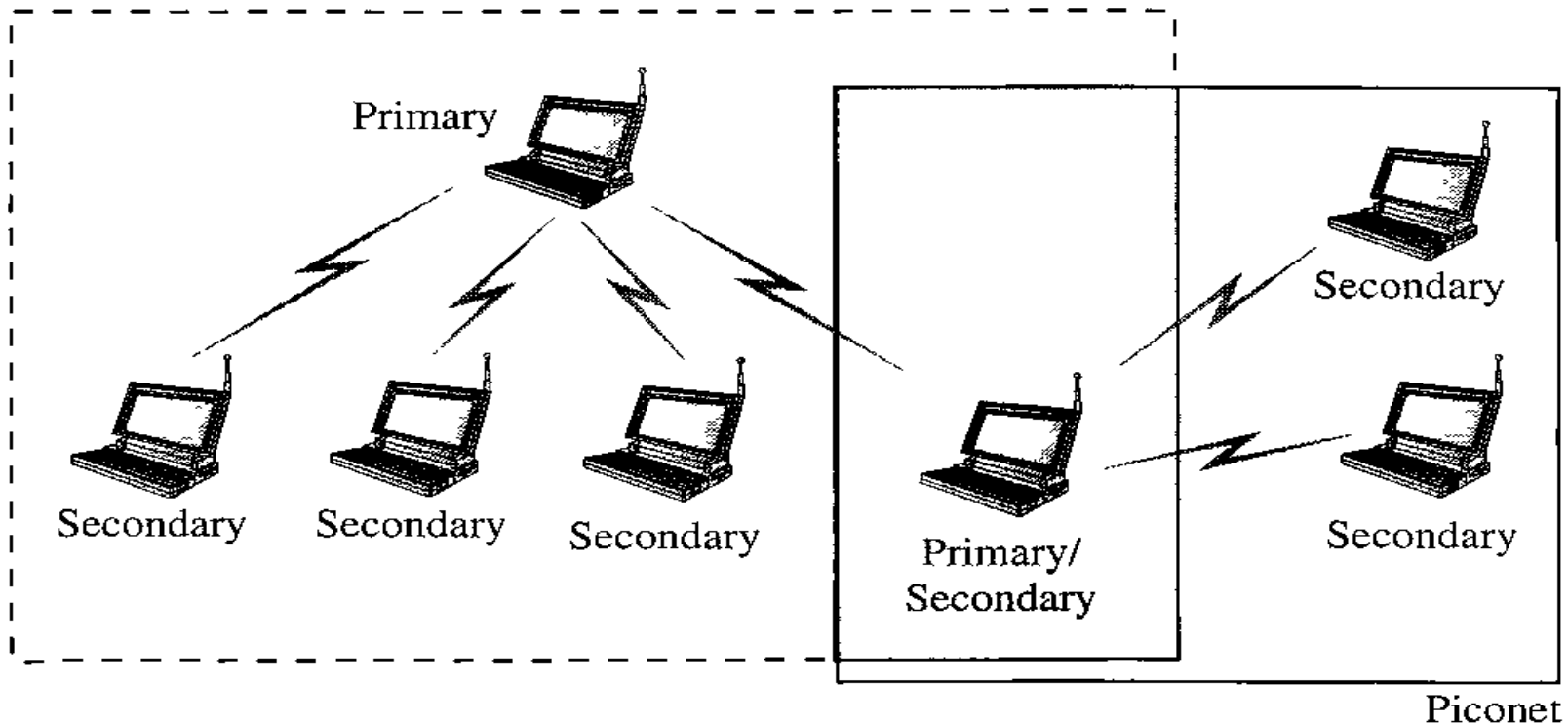
Piconet

- Because only eight stations can be active in a piconet, activating a station from the parked state means that an active station must go to the parked state.

- *Scatternet*

- Piconets can be combined to form what is called a scatternet.
- A secondary station in one piconet can be the primary in another piconet. This station can receive messages from the primary in the first piconet (as a secondary) and, acting as a primary, deliver them to secondaries in the second piconet.
- A station can be a member of two piconets.

Piconet

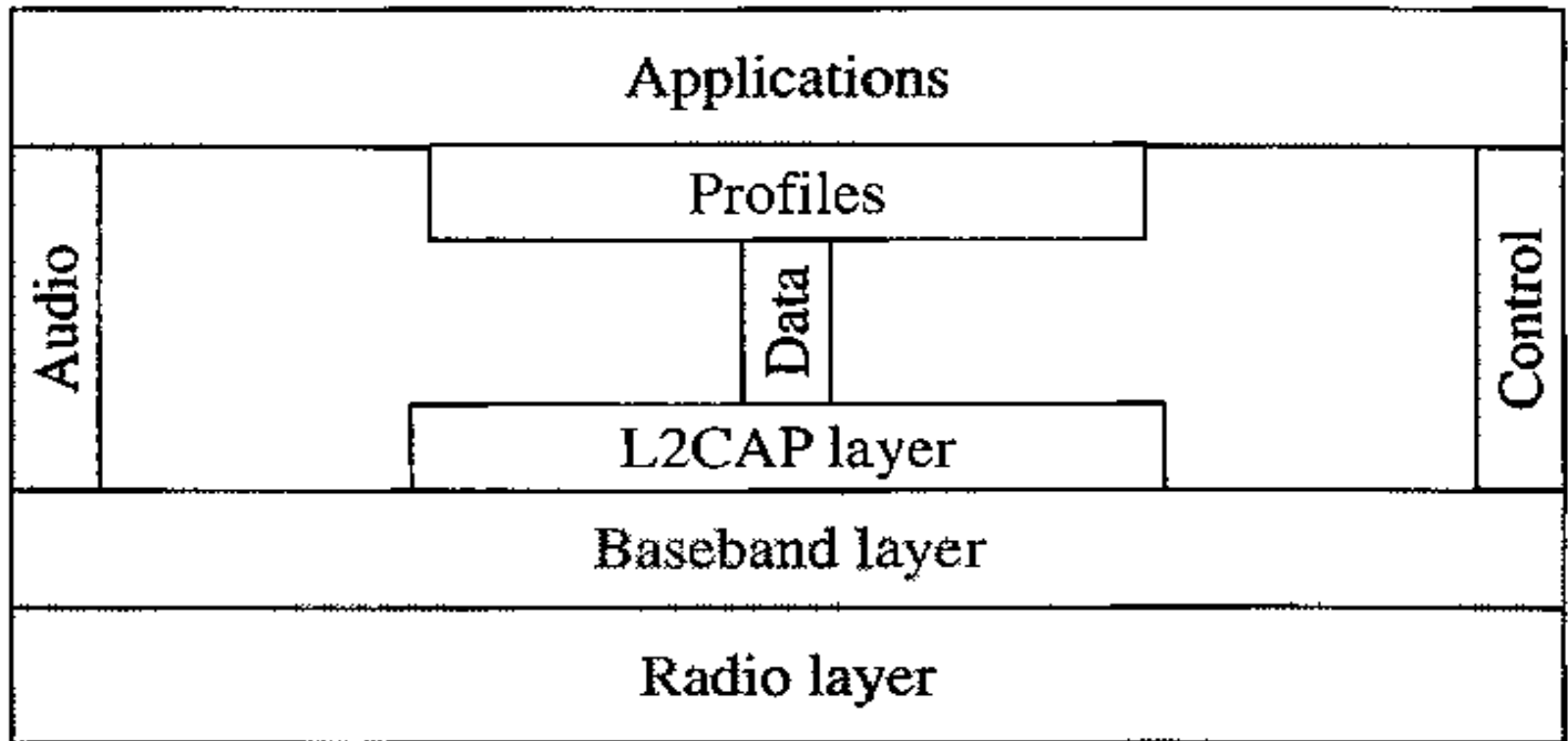


Bluetooth Devices

- A Bluetooth device has a built-in short-range radio transmitter. The current data rate is 1 Mbps with a 2.4-GHz bandwidth. This means that there is a possibility of **interference** between the IEEE 802.11b wireless LANs and Bluetooth LANs.

- **Bluetooth Layers**

- Bluetooth uses several layers that do not exactly match those of the Internet models



- **Radio Layer**

- The radio layer is roughly equivalent to the physical layer of the Internet model.
- Bluetooth devices are low-power and have a range of 10 m.

- *Band*

- Bluetooth uses a 2.4-GHz ISM band divided into 79 channels of 1 MHz each.

- *FHSS*

- Bluetooth uses the frequency-hopping spread spectrum (FHSS) method in the physical layer to avoid interference from other devices or other networks.
- Bluetooth hops 1600 times per second, which means that each device changes its modulation frequency 1600 times per second.
- A device uses a frequency for only 625 μs ($1/1600$ s) before it hops to another frequency; the dwell time is 625 μs .

- *Modulation*

- To transform bits to a signal, Bluetooth uses a sophisticated version of PSK, called GFSK (PSK with Gaussian bandwidth filtering; GFSK has a carrier frequency.
- Bit 1 is represented by a frequency deviation above the carrier; bit 0 is represented by a frequency deviation below the carrier.
- The frequencies, in megahertz, are defined using the formula for each channel:

$$f_c = 2402 + n \quad \text{where } n = 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots, 78$$

Baseband Layer

- The baseband layer is roughly equivalent to the MAC sublayer in LANs.
- The access method is TDMA.
- The primary and secondary communicate with each other using time slots.
- The length of a time slot is exactly the same as the dwell time, 625 μ s.
- This means that during the time that one frequency is used, a sender sends a frame to a secondary, or a secondary sends a frame to the primary.
- Note that the communication is only between the primary and a secondary; secondaries cannot communicate directly with one another.

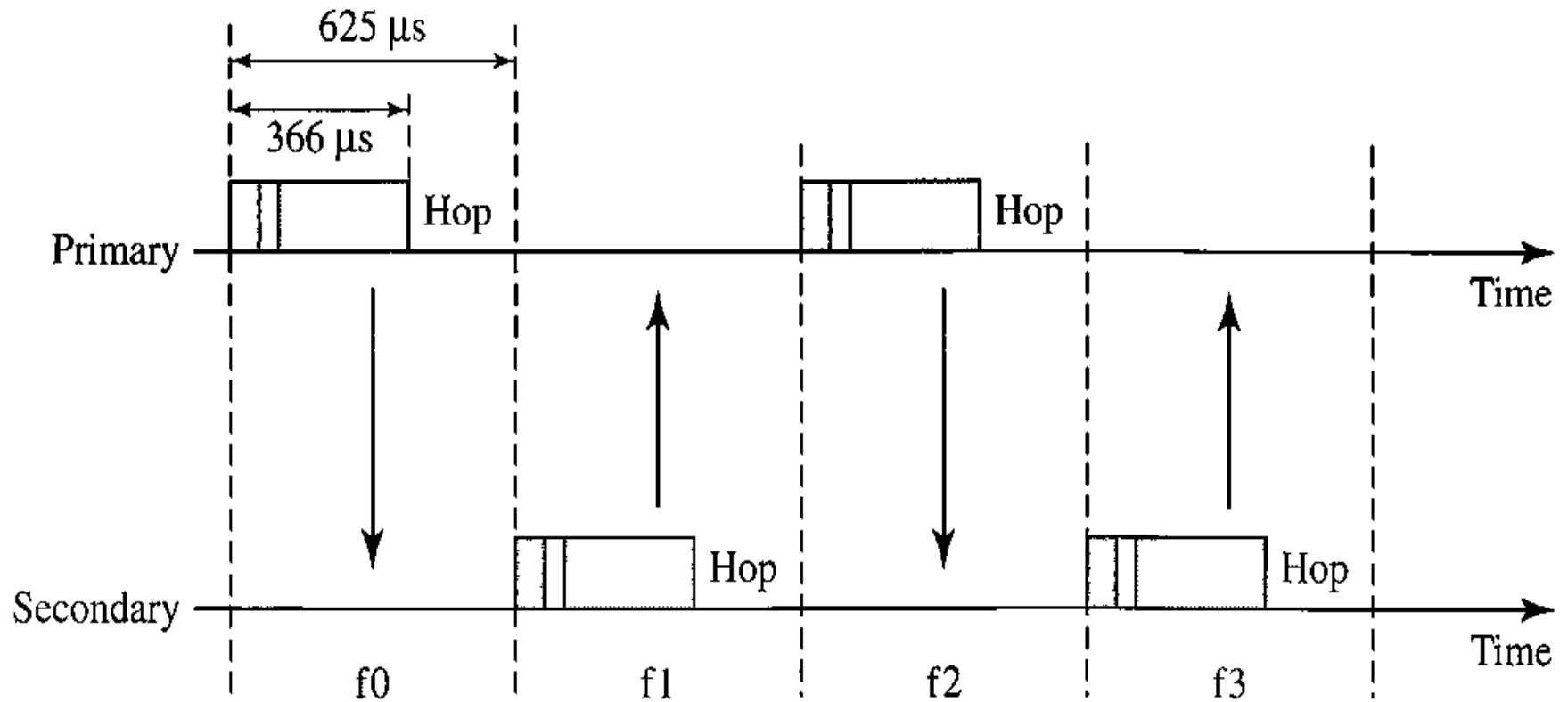
Baseband Layer

- *TDMA*

- Bluetooth uses a form of TDMA that is called TDD-TDMA (time division duplex TDMA).
- TDD-TDMA is a kind of half-duplex communication in which the secondary and receiver send and receive data, but not at the same time (halfduplex)
- however, the communication for each direction uses different hops.
- Single-Secondary Communication If the *piconet* has only one secondary, the TDMA operation is very simple.
- The time is divided into slots of 625 us, The primary uses even numbered slots (0, 2, 4, ...); the secondary uses odd-numbered slots (1, 3, 5, ...).
- TDD-TDMA allows the primary and the secondary to communicate in half-duplex mode.

Baseband Layer

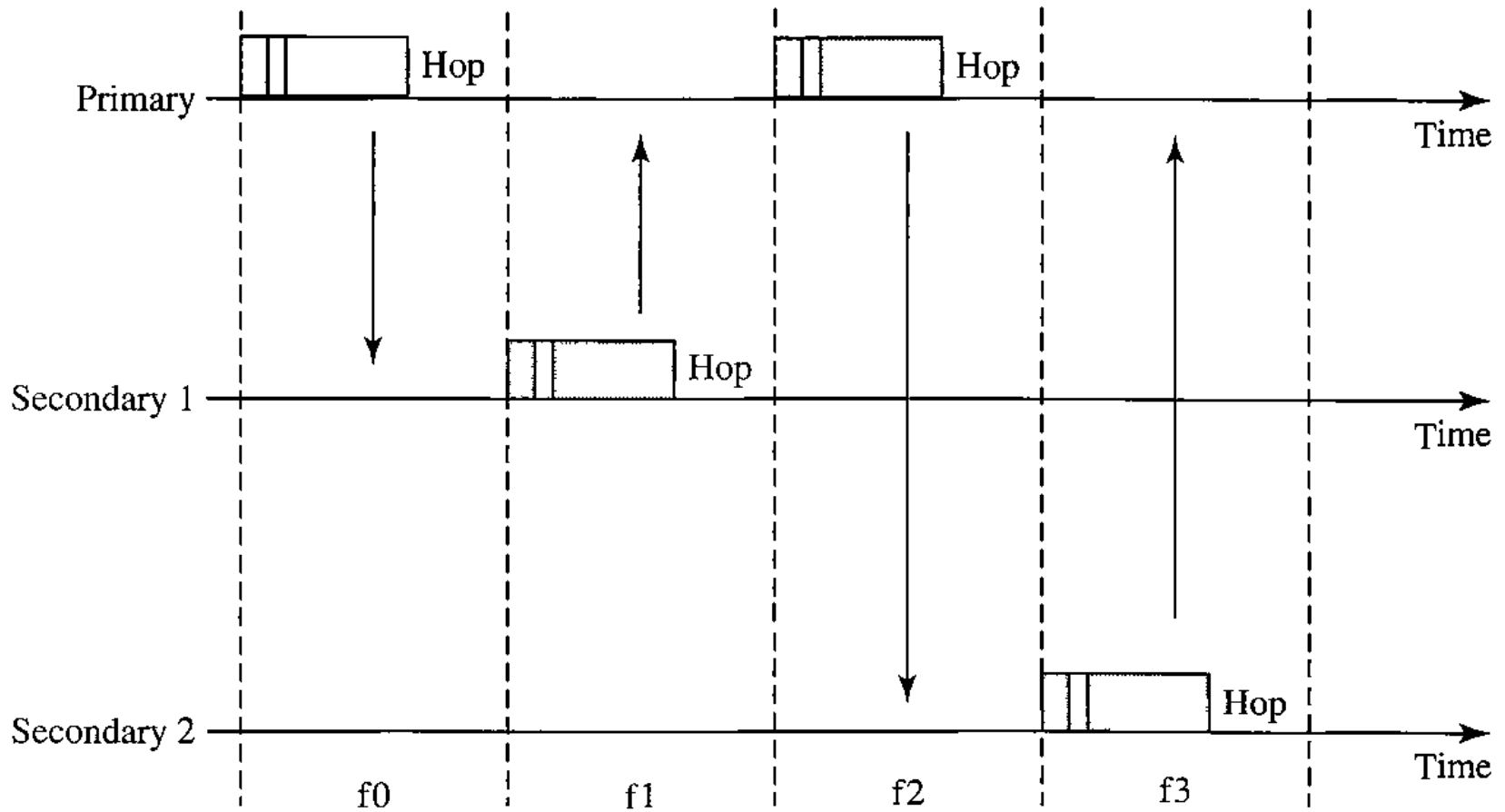
Single-secondary communication



Baseband Layer

- Multiple-Secondary Communication
 - The process is a little more involved if there is more than one secondary in the piconet.
 - Again, the primary uses the even-numbered slots, but a secondary sends in the next odd-numbered slot if the packet in the previous slot was addressed to it.
 - All secondaries listen on even-numbered slots, but only one secondary sends in any odd-numbered slot.

Multiple-Secondary Communication



Multiple-Secondary Communication

- We can say that this access method is similar to a poll/select operation with reservations.
- When the primary selects a secondary, it also polls it. The next time slot is reserved for the polled station to send its frame. If the polled secondary has no frame to send, the channel is silent.

- *Physical Links*

- Two types of links between a primary and a secondary:
- SCO A synchronous connection-oriented (SCO)
 - link is used when avoiding latency (delay in data delivery) is more important than integrity (error-free delivery).
 - a physical link is created between the primary and a secondary by reserving specific slots at regular intervals.
 - The basic unit of connection is two slots, one for each direction. If a packet is damaged, it is never retransmitted.
 - sco is used for real-time audio where avoiding delay is all-important.
 - A secondary can create up to three sco links with the primary, sending digitized audio (PCM) at 64 kbps in each link.

- *Physical Links*

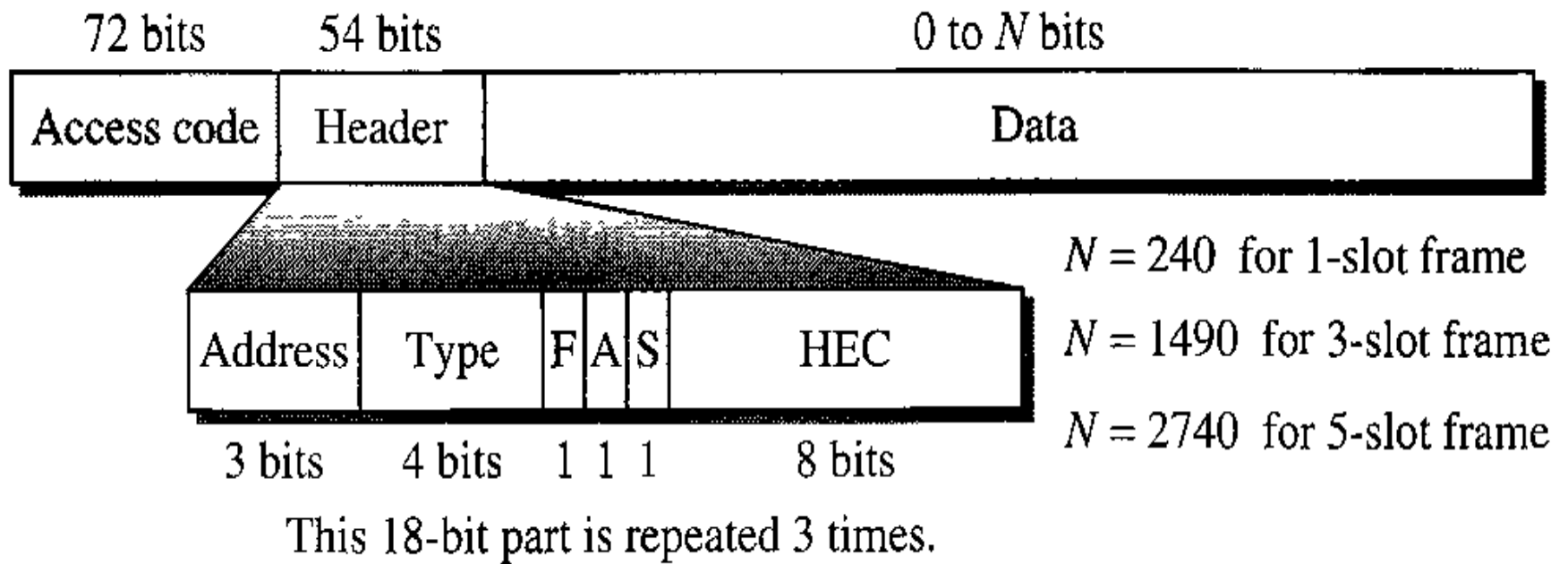
- ACL An asynchronous connectionless **link** (ACL)

- is used when data integrity is more important than avoiding latency. In this type of link, if a payload encapsulated in the frame is corrupted, it is retransmitted.
 - A secondary returns an ACL frame in the available odd-numbered slot if and only if the previous slot has been addressed to it.
 - ACL can use one, three, or more slots and can achieve a maximum data rate of 721 kbps.

- *Frame Format*

- A frame in the baseband layer can be one of three types: one-slot, three-slot, or five-slot.
- A **slot** is 625 us. However, in a one-slot frame exchange, 259 us is needed for hopping and control mechanisms. This means that a one-slot frame can last only **625 - 259**, or 366 us. With a 1-MHz bandwidth and 1 bit/Hz, the size of a one-slot frame is 366 bits.
- A **three-slot frame** occupies three slots. However, since 259 us is used for hopping, the length of the frame is **3 x 625 - 259 = 1616 us** or 1616 bits.
- A device that uses a three-slot frame remains at the same hop (at the same carrier frequency) for three slots.
- Even though only one hop number is used, three hop numbers are consumed. That means the hop number for each frame is equal to the first slot of the frame.
- A **five-slot** frame also uses 259 bits for hopping, which means that the length of the frame is **5 x 625 - 259 = 2866 bits**.

Frame Format



- Access code
 - This 72-bit field normally contains synchronization bits and the identifier of the primary to distinguish the frame of one piconet from another.

Frame Format

- **Header.** This 54-bit field is a repeated 18-bit pattern.
 - **Address.** Can define up to seven secondaries (1 to 7).
If the address is zero, it is used for broadcast communication from the primary to all secondaries.
 - **Type.** The 4-bit type subfield defines the type of data coming from the upper layers.
 - **F.** This 1-bit subfield is for flow control. When set (1), it indicates that the device is unable to receive more frames (buffer is full).
 - **A.** This 1-bit subfield is for acknowledgment. Bluetooth uses Stop-and-Wait ARQ; 1 bit is sufficient for acknowledgment.
 - **S.** This 1-bit subfield holds a sequence number. Bluetooth uses Stop-and-Wait ARQ
 - **HEC.** The 8-bit header error correction subfield is a checksum to detect errors in each 18-bit header section.

Frame Format

- The header has three identical 18-bit sections. The receiver compares these three sections, bit by bit.
- If each of the corresponding bits is the same, the bit is accepted;
- if not, the majority opinion rules. This is a form of forward error correction (for the header only).
- This double error control is needed because the nature of the communication, via air, is very noisy.
- Note that there is no retransmission in this sublayer

Frame Format

- **Payload.** This subfield can be 0 to 2740 bits long. **It** contains data or control information coming from the upper layers.

- **L2CAP**

- The **Logical Link Control and Adaptation Protocol, or L2CAP** (L2 here means LL), is roughly equivalent to the LLC sublayer in LANs.
- It is used for data exchange on an ACL link; SCO channels do not use L2CAP.
- The 16-bit length field defines the size of the data, in bytes, coming from the upper layers.
- Data can be up to 65,535 bytes.
- The channel id (CID) defines a unique identifier for the virtual channel created at this level.
- The L2CAP has specific duties: multiplexing, segmentation and reassembly, quality of service (QoS), and group management.

2 bytes	2 bytes	0 to 65,535 bytes
Length	Channel ID	Data and control

- *Multiplexing*

- The L2CAP can do multiplexing.
- At the sender site, it accepts data from one of the upper-layer protocols, frames them, and delivers them to the baseband layer.
- At the receiver site, it accepts a frame from the baseband layer, extracts the data, and delivers them to the appropriate protocol layer.
- It creates a kind of virtual channel

- *Segmentation and Reassembly*

- The maximum size of the payload field in the baseband layer is 2774 bits, or 343 bytes.
- This includes 4 bytes to define the packet and packet length. Therefore, the size of the packet that can arrive from an upper layer can only be 339 bytes. However, application layers sometimes need to send a data packet that can be up to 65,535 bytes (an Internet packet, for example).
- The L2CAP divides these large packets into segments and adds extra information to define the location of the segments in the original packet.
- The L2CAP segments the packet at the source and reassembles them at the destination.

- *QoS*

- Bluetooth allows the stations to define a quality-of-service level.
- it is sufficient to know that if no quality-of-service level is defined, Bluetooth defaults to what is called *best-effort* service; it will do its best under the circumstances.

- *Group Management*

- Another functionality of L2CAP is to allow devices to create a type of logical addressing between themselves. This is similar to multicasting.
- For example, two or three secondary devices can be part of a multicast group to receive data from the primary.

Reference

- Data and computer communications by William Stallings, Pearson.